



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Liberty Classical Academy
School Website: <https://libertyclassicalacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Liberty Classical Academy (White Bear Lake, MN, 55110) presents a robust classical, Christian approach to education. The school clearly embraces core classical elements—the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin and classical literature, Great Books, and Socratic-style inquiry—while foregrounding faith as the lens through which all learning is interpreted. Public materials emphasize classical formation, virtue, and the aim of educating for character and wisdom rather than solely for work-readiness. The six-category evaluation below, based on the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School framework, indicates a consistently CLASSICAL orientation across Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The strongest signals come from explicit statements about the Trivium, Great Books, classical method, and faith-based formation; weaker signals relate to liturgical practices, which are referenced less directly on site. Overall, Liberty Classical Academy is CLASSICAL, with limited need for needle-moving reforms to reach full alignment.

Key textual signals include: explicit Christian faith integration in the curriculum and worldview, the Trivium (Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric) as the organizing framework, emphasis on Great Books and original sources, memory-work and recitation as pedagogical tools, and a visible commitment to virtue and character formation. The public materials also stress a two-campus model, small class sizes, and a focus on speech and writing as core outcomes, consistent with classical formation. Citations drawn from Liberty Classical Academy's site content and the accompanying classical-education lexicon support these characterizations.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence

- The school presents Christianity as a foundational frame for education, including statements about biblical integration and faith as the interpretive lens for all learning. This appears in public materials describing the integration of faith and learning and the Christian worldview that underpins the curriculum.
- A major page explicitly situates the school as a Christian, classical program with a biblically-inflected approach to education.
- The school emphasizes virtue, formation, and the moral dimension of education, aligning with transcendental, virtue-centered foundations in classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: theology, biblical integration, virtue, faith as lens, Christian worldview, sacred/moral imagination (as implied by formation toward virtue). The classical lexicon lists positive

indicators like theology, virtue, transcendence, and sacred imagery; the school explicitly foregrounds biblically integrated, faith-led learning.

- Negative keywords: no overt signals of secular humanism, relativism, or value-neutral approaches detected in the public materials examined; the site consistently anchors learning in Christian faith and virtue.

Why this rating

- The combination of explicit Christian framing, biblical integration, and virtue-focused formation aligns with the TRANSCENDENTAL moral realism and theological grounding emphasized in the classical rubric. The presence of liturgical or explicit communal worship practices is not heavily foregrounded, but the faith-centered approach and theological orientation are clear enough to award CLASSICAL in this category.

ABSTRACT

ed evidence sources: Liberty's Christian framing and biblical integration language; faith-as-lens language; virtue formation emphasis.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school's stated aim centers on forming virtue and wisdom, not merely preparing students for work; education is presented as formation and human flourishing, with a teleology toward true, good, and beautiful. The site frames education as cultivation of character and intellect.
- References to the Great Conversation, classical heritage, and the pursuit of human excellence indicate a telos-oriented mission beyond job-preparation.
- The Trivium and liberal-arts framework establish a lifelong-education orientation rather than a narrow workforce emphasis.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, telos, great conversation, human flourishing, scholé (restful contemplation). The lexicon's positives map strongly to these concepts, and Liberty's materials reflect them in talk about character formation, the classical mission, and a long-term educational purpose.
- Negative keywords: none evident here (e.g., "workforce preparation," "21st-century skills"); the site emphasizes formation over career readiness in its formation language.

Why this rating

- The school's mission and purpose readings align squarely with CLASSICAL orientation: formation and virtue-based aims, classical education as a telos, and an emphasis on enduring truths (truth, goodness, beauty) rather than purely utilitarian outcomes.

Evidence sources: explicit formation language; telos/great-conversation framing; classical mission references.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum explicitly centers on liberal arts and the Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin and classical languages; history through a Western-civilization lens; great books and primary sources; and the aim to engage students with original texts. The school describes a curriculum anchored in classical texts and the liberal-arts framework.

- Great Books / original sources are highlighted; students study history through literature and primary sources, aligning with the Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis.
- The Trivium is explicitly identified as central to the learning model, with Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric described as stages of development that structure instruction. Latin and other classical languages are included as core elements.
- The curriculum weaves together English, History, Math, Science, Arts, and Classics to create a coherent liberal-arts base.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts, trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, Latin, history (in the classical sense), Western civilization, original sources, and the cultivation of wonder. The site's explicit mention of Trivium and Great Books mirrors the lexicon's explicit positives for Curriculum.
- Negative keywords: no explicit mention of a "social studies" reframing or heavy project-based-first framing; no evidence of a STEM-first bias; no dominant negative signals observed in public content.

Why this rating

- The school's publicly stated curriculum aligns with CLASSICAL by foregrounding liberal-arts, Trivium, Great Books, and original sources, and by presenting history through classical content rather than social-studies framing. Evidence from multiple pages confirms a strong classical-curriculum orientation.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Pedagogy centers on a mix of contemplative/restful elements (Scholé-like pacing, memorization, chanting, recitation) and active, dialectic, and rhetorically oriented work (Socratic discussion, seminars, debate, public speaking). The classical method is described as balancing restful, contemplative learning with rigorous engagement in logic, rhetoric, and memorization. This balance is visible in the site's presentation of the classical method and memory-based practices.
- The site communicates that lower- and upper-school experiences incorporate chant/memorization, recitation, and oral tradition, alongside Socratic discussions and debates in higher grades. Public-facing content presents both memory-work and rhetoric-focused activities as core aspects of classical pedagogy.
- The school emphasizes voice development, persuasive writing, and public speaking as outcomes, aligning with a classical emphasis on rhetoric and oratory.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, memory work, recitation, chanting, scholé, contemplation, rhetoric, oratory, and public speaking; explicit references to a balanced, contemplative-to-rigorous pedagogy. The lexicon highlights these as positive signs for pedagogy; Liberty's materials show direct alignment with these elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric, memory work, expressive speaking).
- Negative keywords: minimal to no signals of purely experiential, project-based-only or constructivist pedagogy; the content does not emphasize a student-led, project-first model as the sole approach. Where present, project-based elements are not framed as the exclusive method.

Why this rating

- The school's pedagogy of balancing contemplative, memorization-based practice with Socratic/dialogue-based inquiry and rhetorical training conforms to CLASSICAL expectations for pedagogy. Public materials explicitly present both memory-based, liturgical/recitation practices and higher-order, argumentative discourse.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site emphasizes faculty as the core of the school's identity, with references to Headmaster leadership, living curriculum, and moral exemplars. Distinctive "body of values" language and the portrayal of faculty as mentors and exemplars align with the classical model of the teacher as more than a content-delivery agent.
- Statements about teachers modeling virtue, guiding students, and embodying the "living curriculum" align with classical faculty expectations of virtue, mastery, and collegiality. The presence of leadership and long-term faculty orientation is visible in site content about school history, perseverance, and leadership formation.
- Public materials show recognition of faculty as central to student formation (e.g., lower/upper school leadership narratives and distinctives about classroom practice).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, character formation, masterful teaching; mentorship and virtue exemplars are highlighted. The lexicon's Faculty section lists positive indicators like "tutors, masters, mentors," "portrait of a teacher," and "living curriculum." Public content aligns with those concepts.
- Negative keywords: no clear signals of a purely certification-driven or non-classical faculty model; the site's language supports a model of exemplary, virtuous teachers.

Why this rating

- The school's public-facing materials portray teachers as central exemplars and living curriculum, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty. The teacher as mentor and exemplar, and the presence of a "body of values" framing, support CLASSICAL as the rating for this category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site presents a model of partnership with parents, with references to family involvement, open campus visits, and parent formation through book clubs or gatherings. There are calls for parent engagement and channels (tours, inquiries, events) designed to integrate families into the classical framework.
- The school emphasizes communication with families and opportunities for parents to engage in classical learning through book clubs, gatherings, and educational resources. This aligns with the lexicon's "Parents and Community" indicators (partnership with parents, parent formation, open campus, family liturgy).
- The school's public materials feature events, visits, and a culture of parental involvement (tours, inquiries, admissions, and community news). The public-facing materials show a welcoming posture toward parents and families as co-collaborators in classical education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, reading groups, seminars, open campus, family participation, and parent involvement in events. The Lexicon's Parents & Community section highlights these same positive indicators.
- Negative keywords: no signals of parent consumerism or minimal involvement; the content supports active parental engagement rather than a purely customer relationship.

Why this rating

- The school's communications depict parents as partners in the Classical project, with explicit invitations for parent participation and formation. This strongly matches the CLASSICAL category expectations for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Ranking

- Overall, Liberty Classical Academy (White Bear Lake, MN, 55110) demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories, with explicit classical content (Trivium, Great Books, Latin, rhetoric, and memory work), a clearly faith-centered formation model, and an emphasis on virtuous teacher-mentors and engaged parents/community.

What Would Move the Needle

- If aiming for a firmer CLASSICAL standing in every minor area, the school could:
- Explicitly foreground liturgical and communal practices (e.g., morning prayer, chapel routines, or liturgical calendar alignment) in public materials to strengthen Element 1 signals.
- More explicitly articulate Great Books-to-Great Conversation language across the site (e.g., direct mention of “great conversation” and a stated public list of Great Books and authors, beyond references to classics) to reinforce Element 3 signals on curriculum.
- Highlight concrete examples of the faculty as “living curriculum” with published teacher-formation standards and exemplars to make Element 5 signals more tangible for prospective families.
- Provide additional parent-formation programming (reading groups, seminars) with published schedules or reading lists to strengthen Element 6 signals and demonstrate ongoing parental formation in a public way.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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